

PE Lesson Extensions: City Stroll, The Safe Pedestrian

Lesson Overview:

In this lesson, students will learn and practice essential pedestrian safety skills, focusing on environmental awareness and communication with drivers. Students will navigate a simulated city environment, learning to cross safely, respond to traffic signals, and identify potential hazards.

This lesson is best suited for students in 1st-3rd grades.

Standards Alignment

SHAPE America National PE Standards

- **Standard 2: Applies knowledge related to movement and fitness concepts.**
 - 2.2.1 Recognizes personal space and where to move in general space.
 - 2.5.1 Applies movement concepts and strategies for safe movement within dynamic environments.
- **Standard 3: Develops social skills through movement.**
 - 3.2.6 Describes why following rules are important for safety and fairness.
 - 3.5.4 Demonstrates safe behaviors independently with limited reminders.

Objective

Students will be able to:

- Demonstrate proper crossing techniques at designated crosswalks and intersections, avoiding crossing between parked cars.
- Identify and follow traffic signals (Walk/Don't Walk) while wearing bright/reflective gear for visibility.
- Practice traffic awareness by making direct eye contact with drivers to ensure they have stopped.
- Demonstrate safe mid-block crossing responsibilities by yielding to vehicles and walking on the left side facing traffic.
- Identify environmental hazards such as turning vehicles, driveways, and obscured sightlines.



Materials:

- + **Cones:** 30-40 cones to outline city streets, intersections, and driveways
- + **Poly Spots:** 20-30 to create designated crosswalks at intersections
- + **Pinnies or Reflective Vests:** Brightly colored vests for half the class (pedestrians)
- + **Plastic Hoops or Scooter Boards:** One per student in the driver role to simulate vehicles
- + **Cardboard Boxes or Tall Hurdles:** 4-6 to represent parked cars or blocked sightlines
- + **Red/Green/Walk/Don't Walk Signs:** 2-4 handheld signs for the teacher or volunteer crossing guards
- + **Exit Ticket:** Included at the end of this lesson plan

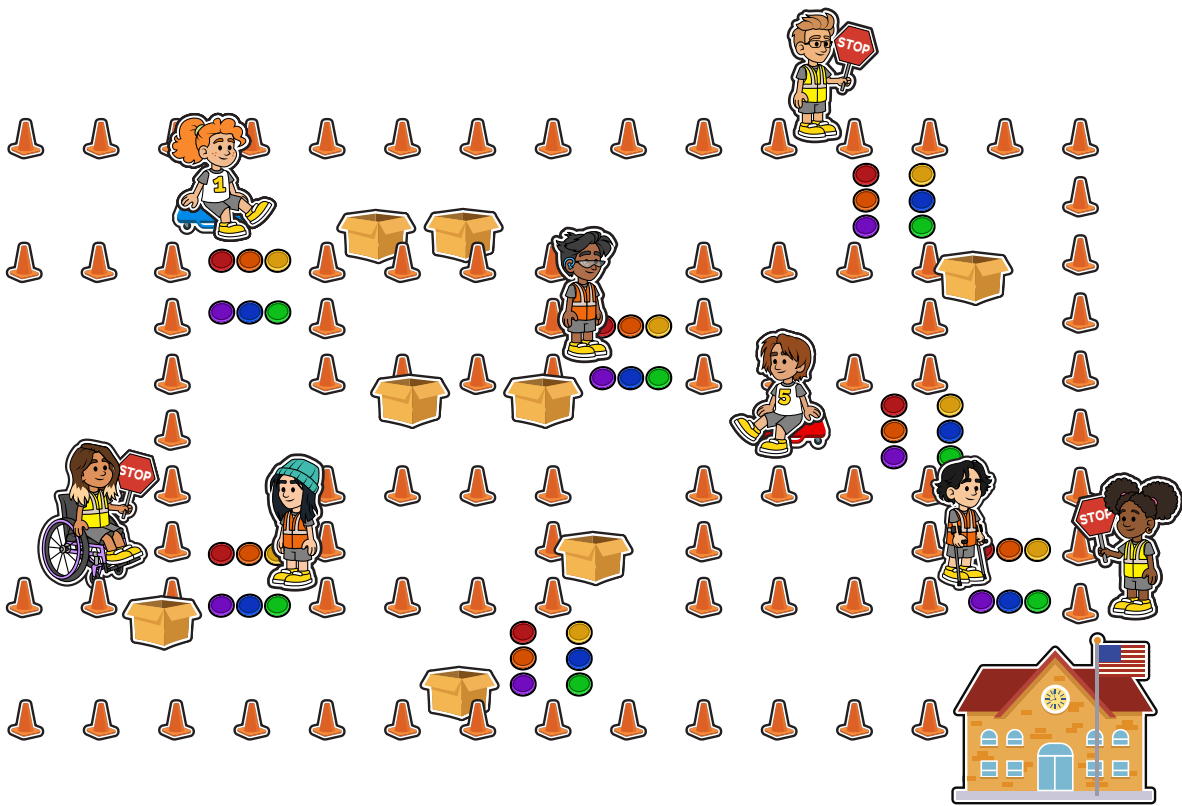
Lesson

Warm-Up: Red Light, Green Light: Eye Contact Edition (5 minutes)

- **Setup:** One student or the teacher acts as the traffic light at the end of the gym. The rest of the students start at the opposite baseline.
- **Activity:** On a green light, students walk forward. At a red light, students must stop completely. **Stress the following:** Before moving on a green light, the student must make direct eye contact with the traffic light, state their intent to cross, and point to where they are walking. If the traffic light catches a student moving without first making eye contact, that student takes three steps back at the next red light.
- **Focus:** Traffic awareness, recognizing signals, and the importance of eye contact before moving

Game Setup: The City Stroll (15-20 minutes)

- Create a city grid using cones to form roads, intersections, and driveways. Place poly spots to create clear crosswalks at the intersections.
- Place boxes or hurdles near some crosswalks to represent parked cars that block visibility.
- **Define the Roles:** Divide the class into two groups: pedestrians (wearing bright pinnies) and drivers (holding plastic hoops as steering wheels and walking, or carefully rolling on scooter boards).
- **The Challenge:** Pedestrians must travel from their home base to the school base while safely navigating the streets, while drivers circulate the roads.



Gameplay: The City Stroll (5 minutes)

Step	Action	Description & Teaching Cues
1. The Approach	Proper Crossing	Pedestrians approach the poly spot crosswalks. They must stop at the curb and never cross between the parked car boxes.
2. The Signal	Signaling & Visibility	Pedestrians must wait for the teacher or crossing guard to show the walk sign. They are wearing bright pinnies to ensure they are seen.
3. The Check	Traffic Awareness	Before stepping into the crosswalk, pedestrians look left-right-left. They must make eye contact with the approaching driver and receive a nod or a wave that the vehicle is stopped.
4. The Hazard	Environmental Hazards	As they walk the sidewalks, pedestrians must pause and look before crossing driveways (marked by smaller cones) to check for turning vehicles.
5. Switch	Rotation	After successfully reaching the school, pedestrians and drivers switch equipment and roles.

Variation — Mid-Block Crossing Challenge:

Mid-Block Crossing Challenge. Remove the poly spot crosswalks. Instruct pedestrians that if they must cross without a crosswalk, they must first yield to all drivers. Additionally, have pedestrians practice walking on the left side of the road (if no sidewalks exist) so they are facing the oncoming drivers.



Cool Down and Reflection (5 minutes)

- **Traffic Light Stretch:**

- *Green:* Stand tall on tiptoes and reach high to the sky.
- *Yellow:* Bend at the waist and hang arms down slowly.
- *Red:* Sit on the floor, stretch legs wide, and hold a static stretch for a count of ten.
Repeat three times.

Reflection → Ask Students:

- **Traffic Awareness:** Why is it so important to make eye contact with a driver before you step into the street?
 - Answer: It is the only reliable way to confirm that the driver actually sees you.
- **Proper Crossing:** What makes crossing between parked cars dangerous?
 - Answer: Drivers cannot see you, and you cannot see the drivers.
- **Signaling & Visibility:** How did wearing the bright pinnie help the drivers notice you today? Describe what you should wear if you are walking at dusk or night.
 - Possible Answers: White clothing over dark clothing, reflective clothing, a vest, or clip-on safety lights
- **Mid-Block Crossing:** If there is no crosswalk, who has the right of way: the pedestrian or the car?
 - Answer: The car has the right of way. However, pedestrians should always wait until it is safe to cross, and drivers must do everything possible to avoid a collision.

Modifications:

- **The Clear View Option:** For students who might be overwhelmed by navigating around visual barriers, remove the parked car boxes to provide a clear, unobstructed line of sight to all vehicles.
- **Auditory Signals:** For visually impaired students, use a whistle, bell, or verbal walk-or-don't-walk cues in addition to the visual signs. Pair them with a sighted peer for the eye contact portion of the lesson.
- **Pacing the Drivers:** If drivers are moving too fast for pedestrians to safely practice their checks, implement a slow-motion zone rule where vehicles must move at half-speed at all times.



Name: _____

Date: _____

Pedestrian Safety Check

Mark your answer choice for each question.

How well do you understand how to cross the street safely?

- ☐ Great (I know all the steps.)
- ☐ Okay (I know most of the steps.)
- ☐ Not so good (I need more practice.)

Traffic Awareness: Did you look left-right-left and make eye contact with the driver today?

- ☐ Yes, I did.
- ☐ I'm not sure.
- ☐ No, I forgot.

Proper Crossing: Is it safe to cross the street by walking between two parked cars?

- ☐ Yes, it's a good shortcut.
- ☐ No, because drivers cannot see me.
- ☐ I'm not sure.

Signaling and Visibility: Why is it important to wear bright or reflective clothing when walking?

- ☐ To let drivers see me easily.
- ☐ To keep me warm.
- ☐ To help me run faster.

Mid-Block Crossing: If you need to cross the street but there is no crosswalk, who has the right of way (who gets to go first)?

- ☐ The pedestrian.
- ☐ The vehicle (car).
- ☐ Whoever is in the biggest hurry.